Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣J

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥8

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥4

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠K

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 10 8 3 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ Q J 3	
♠ A 6 2 ♥ 9 8 5 4 ♦ J 7 5 ♣ 9 8 5		♠ 9 4 ♥ K Q 10 6 3 ♦ 10 4 2 ♣ A 7 4
	♠ Q J 7 5 ♥ A ♦ A K Q 3 ♣ K 10 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1♦.

NORTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1♠.

SOUTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 5
♥ A J 9 8
♦ K 8 5
♣ Q 8 7 5

♠ 10 9 6 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ Q 7
♣ A K 6 4



♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A J 6
♣ 9 3

♠ 8 2
♥ 10 6 3
♦ 10 9 4 3 2
♣ J 10 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♣J

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

EAST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. WEST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. EAST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. WEST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 10 8 ♥ A J 6 ♦ K 10 9 3 ♣ Q 10 5	
♠ A 9 6 4 ♥ 9 8 4 3 2 ♦ 8 7 2 ♣ 3		♠ 7 5 2 ♥ 10 7 ♦ 6 5 4 ♣ A 9 8 7 6
	♠ K J 3 ♥ K Q 5 ♦ A Q J ♣ K J 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

4NT by South
Lead: ♥8

SOUTH has a perfect 2NT opening hand, 20 points and 3-3-3-4 distribution.

NORTH, with 12 points of his own, knows the partnership is borderline strong enough for slam. Since he is happy with Notrump, he invites SOUTH to bid slam by responding 4NT.

With one more point SOUTH might bid the slam, but here she just passes.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ K Q 7 3
♥ 10 4 3
♦ Q J 2
♣ A 5 4

♠ 9 6 5
♥ K Q 2
♦ A 8 7
♣ K Q J 3



♠ J 10 4
♥ A J 6
♦ K 5 3
♣ 10 8 7 2

♠ A 8 2
♥ 9 8 7 5
♦ 10 9 6 4
♣ 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2NT	
All Pass			

2NT by West
Lead: ♥4

WEST opens 1NT with 15 points and a balanced hand.

EAST, with 9 points, cannot bid game herself, but she can invite WEST to bid game if he has the maximum 17 point opener. So she responds 2NT.

WEST doesn't have maximum, he has minimum, so he passes.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 9 7 5 ♥ 6 4 2 ♦ A K J ♣ 7 4 2	
♠ A 6 4 3 ♥ J 10 7 5 3 ♦ 2 ♣ J 9 8		♠ K ♥ Q 9 8 ♦ Q 10 9 8 5 3 ♣ 10 6 3
	♠ Q 10 8 2 ♥ A K ♦ 7 6 4 ♣ A K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

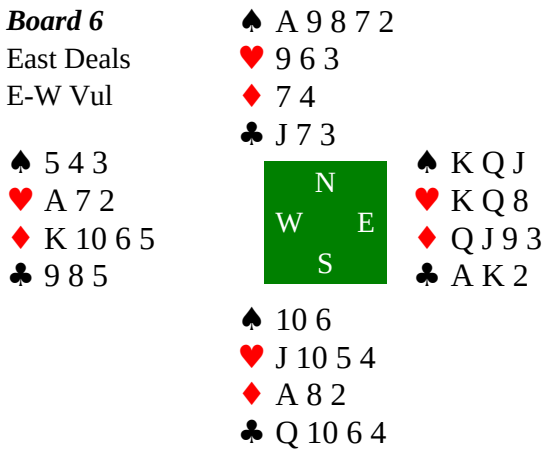
4♠ by North
Lead: ♠K

SOUTH is 1 point too strong to open 1NT, so opens 1♣.

NORTH responds in his 4-card Major suit, 1♠.

SOUTH now shows her 4-card support plus her extra strength by jumping to 3♠ and NORTH bids the game.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥4

EAST has a classic 2NT opening bid, 21 points and balanced distribution.

WEST knows that her 7 points will be plenty for game, but not enough to consider slam so she just bids 3NT.